SHOULD WE BAN

AI IN HIGHER EDUCATION?

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An FWF Cluster of Excellence

Young AI Leaders Community

Linz Hub

SHOULD WE BAN

AI IN HIGHER EDUCATION?

YES

Dr. Tim Crane
Director of Research
at Knowledge in Crisis

NO

Bram van Haver
Lead Project Officer,
UNESCO Youth for Peace

Dr. Erich Kobler
JKU Asst. Professor,
Bilateral AI Researcher

Anamaria Hartl
JKU PhD candidate,
Bilateral AI Member

Sarah Hinteregger
MA Philosophy
Student, CEU

Tamas Klement
BA Data Science &
Society Student, CEU

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Bram van Haver

Lead Project Officer of Youth for Peace,
UNESCO's intercultural leadership program

“The question is not whether AI belongs in higher education, but how we ensure it enhances learning, strengthens critical thinking, and preserves human agency.”

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Lead Project Officer of Youth for Peace,
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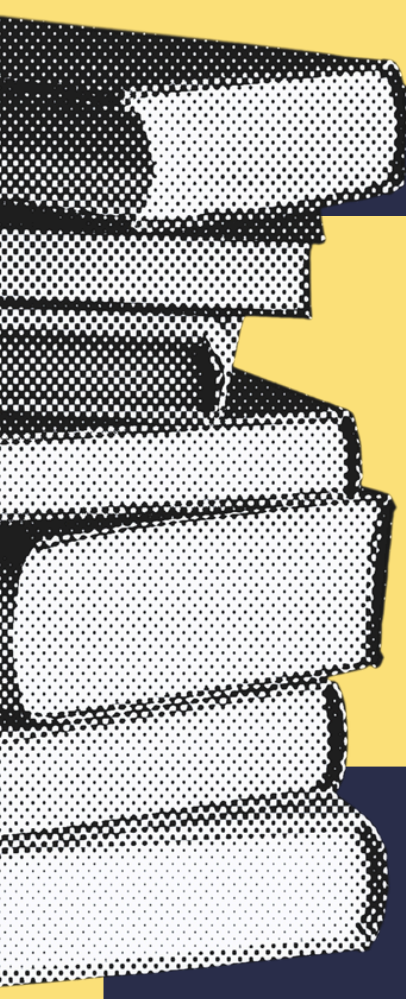
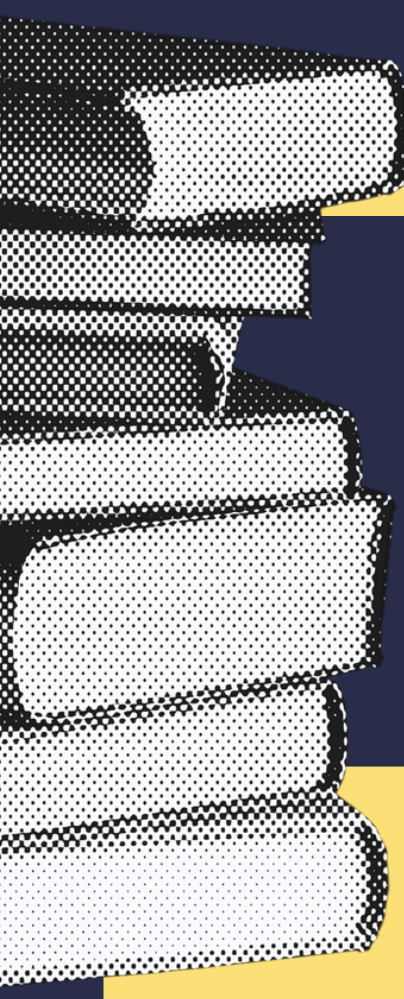


Dr. Tim Crane

Professor of Philosophy at CEU and Director of Research at Knowledge in Crisis

“AI tools are having terrible effects on research and education in universities. If we don’t think about it clearly, AI will destroy education as we know it.”



Dr. Tim Crane

Professor of Philosophy at CEU and Director of Research at Knowledge in Crisis

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Anamaria-Roberta Hartl

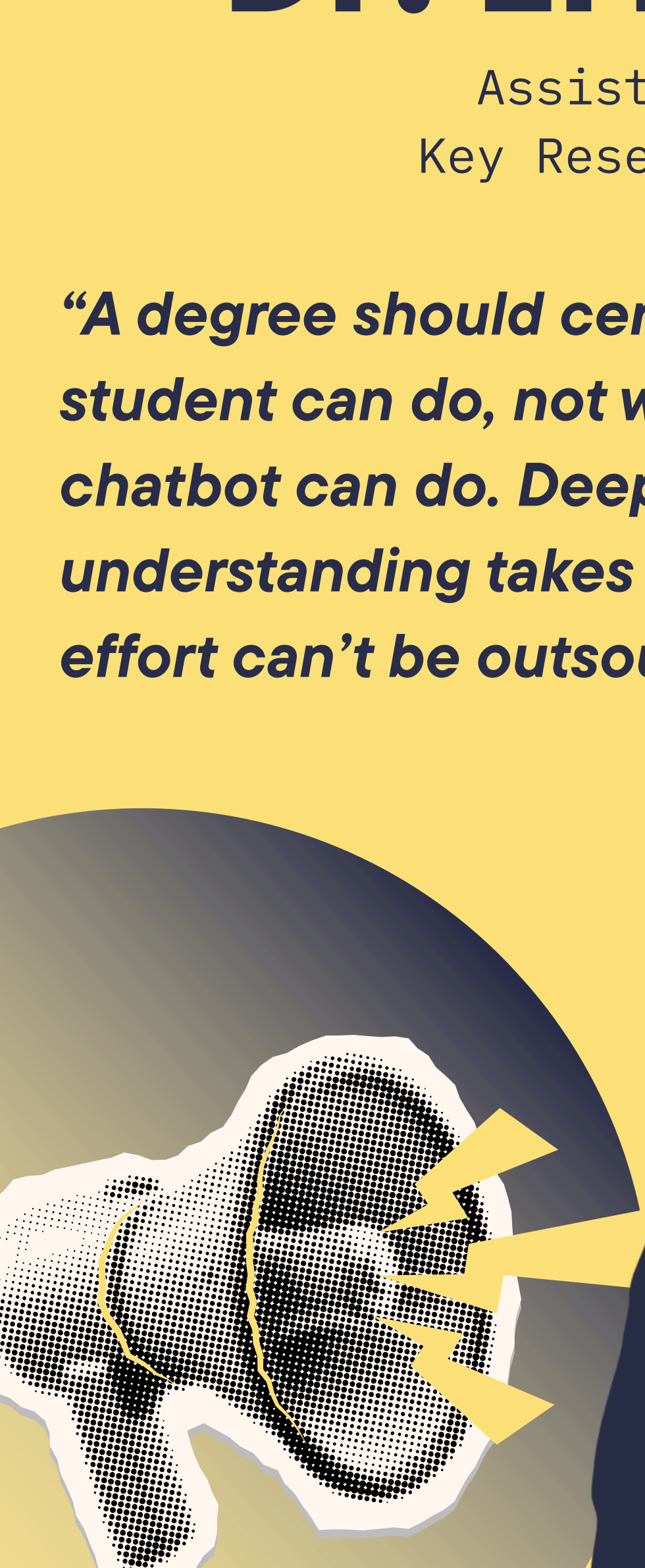
PhD candidate at JKU and a member of Bilateral AI

“Using a chatbot in higher education is not about getting the right answers, but about being able to ask it the right questions.”

Dr. Erich Kobler

Assistant Professor at JKU and
Key Researcher with Bilateral AI

“A degree should certify what a student can do, not what their chatbot can do. Deep understanding takes effort, and effort can’t be outsourced.”



Tamas Klement

BA Data Science & Society student at CEU

"We all know those people. Doing the laundry, setting up a bank account, or taking care of a pet? Easy stuff – in theory.

Yet, when they move away from home, they collapse under the weight of all these responsibilities.
Dear Society, please do not create university students like that when it comes to AI."

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MA Philosophy student at CEU

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ABOUT

This Oxford-style debate presents two opposing views on one controversial motion: “This House Believes That AI should never be used within Higher Education.” We’re bringing a philosopher, computer scientists, a policy expert, and your fellow students together to go head-to-head! Join us to hear their views, share your own, and vote for which arguments you find the most compelling!

5:10 PM

Registration and doors open

5:30 PM

Program starts

5:30 – 5:40 PM

Welcome, event introduction, debate format, and house rules

5:40 – 5:50 PM

Motion contextualisation speech by Niklas Baumgärtler, Area Director of Toastmasters Linz

5:50 – 6:25 PM

Main debate session

6:25 – 6:30 PM

Vote!

6:30 – 6:55 PM

Q&A

6:55 – 7:00 PM

Closing remarks and transition to post-debate reception

The conversation doesn't end when the debate does.

We invite you to apply for a seat at our exclusive post-debate reception. This closed-door networking event is designed to connect key stakeholders with our esteemed speaker lineup, event organizers, and a highly curated group of engaged students.

Secure your free ticket now

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TOASTMASTERS INTERNATIONAL

BilAI

OFFICIAL PARTNER EVENT OF EUROPEAN AI INNOVATION MONTH AND ROAD TO GENEVA

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TOASTMASTERS INTERNATIONAL

European Commission

European AI Innovation Month

BILAI

TEAM

Should We Ban AI in Higher Education?

October 22, 2026

Zirkus des Wissens

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